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PATHAO & SHOHOZ TICKET- SELLING SCANDAL IN BANGLADESH

Key events, allegations, response, and lessons

Background

- Shohoz.com partnered with Bangladesh Railways as the official e-ticket vendor.
- Handled millions of ticket bookings digitally to reduce black-market sales.

Timeline of Key Incidents

- Oct 2022: Engineer charged with black-market ticket sales.
- Mar 2024: RAB arrests 9, including 4 Shohoz staff for involvement in ticket syndicate.
- Mar 2025: Shohoz peon and others arrested for selling 500 tickets/day.
- Jun 2025: Shohoz fined for duplicate ticket sales.
- 2018: Pathao App accused of harvesting SMS, contacts, and hardware data without proper consent—a major breach .

Mechanics of the Scandal

- Employees abused booking system access.
- Syndicate split profits; insiders timed high-demand ticket releases.
- Used real-time access and customer data to control resale.

Consequences and Responses

- Multiple arrests and charge-sheets filed.
- Shohoz fined ~Tk 2 lakh for duplicate sales.
- Shohoz claimed internal malpractice, not organizational failure.

Impact on Users

- Public trust declined due to missing tickets and overbooking.
- Protests erupted at Kamalapur station over poor ticket management.

Measures Taken

- OTP-linked bookings and QR/ID verification introduced.
- Refund delays randomized to disrupt black-market resellers.
- Railways capped tickets per person and mandated ID verification.
- Limit pathao app data collection and enforce transparent privacy policies.

Lessons Learned

- Insider fraud requires active monitoring and layered security.
- Transparency and strong consumer rights are essential.
- Authentication and access limits needed in ticketing systems.

Outlook and Recommendations

- Implement real-time audit logs and privilege limitations.
- Introduce biometric verification for high-demand routes.
- Raise consumer awareness about secure bookings.
- Expand ticketing access through apps and kiosks.

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BKASH SCANDAL IN BANGLADESH

Digital Hundi, Fraud, and Security Challenges

Background

- bKash is Bangladesh's leading mobile financial service (MFS) provider.
- Processes trillions of taka in transactions annually.

Key Scandals & Incidents

- May 2025: 2,887 agent accounts closed for money laundering.
- May 2023: Tk 46 crore laundered via distributor house.
- Apr 2023: Youths arrested for conducting hundi via bKash.
- 2020–2024: Numerous scams via phishing and fake bKash support calls.

High-Profile Scam Cases

- Renowned Actress account hacked; lost Tk 160,000.
- Tea vendor scammed out of Tk 65,000 via fake customer service call.
- Gangs arrested for OTP theft and SIM fraud using agent logbooks.

Mechanism of Fraud

- Phishing via SMS and voice calls posing as bKash support.
- Social engineering to extract OTP and PIN.
- Agents misused logbook data to target customers.

Consequences and Law Enforcement

- Multiple arrests by CID, RAB, DB police.
- bKash blocked rogue agents and refunded some victims.
- CID filed lawsuits for large-scale laundering operations.

Impact on Users

- Frequent financial losses reported daily.
- Most victims are unaware of fraud tactics.
- Significant trust issues among rural users.

bKash's Response

- Awareness campaigns: urging not to share OTPs/PINs.
- Collaborations with law enforcement.
- Limited fraud prevention through app restrictions.

Lessons and Recommendations

- Educate users through ongoing campaigns.
- Enhance app security: device lock, OTP throttling.
- Audit agents regularly; detect abnormal behavior.
- Strengthen legal enforcement and data protection.

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CREDIT CARD SCANDAL IN BANGLADESH

Major Incidents, Impact, and Prevention Measures

Background

- Growth in credit card use in Bangladesh.
- Dual-currency cards allow international purchases.
- Growing fraud risk with increased adoption.

Major Scandals and Incidents

- Sikder Family (2021–2022): Spent \$10M+ using credit cards, National Bank fined.
- 2024: Dual-currency fraud using social media data.
- 2022: ATM ring arrested with cloned cards (Turkish national).
- 2018: POS data skimmed in Banani; City Bank reimbursed customers.
- 2018: DBBL ATM booth hacked by Ukraine nationals
- 2022: Hackers loaded funds from stolen Visa/Mastercard into bKash.

Fraud Mechanisms

- Card cloning through skimming devices at ATMs/POS.
- Exploitation of dual-currency features and data leaks.
- Weak security and insider access in banks.

Consequences & Enforcement

- National Bank fined; Sikder family banned from card usage.
- Fraud gangs arrested by CID and Detective Branch.
- Banks pushed to enhance card security and monitoring.

Impact on Consumers

- Loss of funds and unauthorized transactions.
- Increased concern over card usage safety.
- Banks faced pressure for transparency and protection.

Bank and Regulator Responses

- Bangladesh Bank mandates chip cards, 2FA, OTP.
- Banks adopted AI/ML for fraud detection.
- Faster reimbursement and customer education programs.

Lessons & Recommendations

- Phase out magnetic stripe cards completely.
- Use biometric/MFA for high-value transactions.
- Strengthen fraud awareness for customers.
- Audit internal bank systems and access control.

PROFESSION AND PROFESSIONALISM IN ENGINEERING

Lecture 5 – Engineering Ethics



LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Define Profession and Professionalism
- Understand the models of professional engineers
- Explore professional virtues and ideals
- Analyze how professionalism supports ethical behavior in engineering



WHAT IS A PROFESSION?

- A job or occupation pursued to earn a living
- Key Characteristics: Advanced expertise, Self-regulation, Service to public good



ADVANCED EXPERTISE

- Requires sound knowledge in technical and liberal arts domains
- Continuous learning and upskilling are essential



SELF-REGULATION

- Governed by admission standards and codes of ethics
- Public and governmental representation



SERVING THE PUBLIC GOOD

- Ethical conduct contributes to societal welfare
- High standards in practice benefit individuals and communities



WHO IS A PROFESSIONAL?

- Engages in a profession for livelihood and legal/moral duties
- Robert Whitelaw: Freedom from coercion
- Samuel Florman: Laws > conscience
- Martin & Schinzinger: Moral responsibility to stakeholders



MODELS OF PROFESSIONAL ENGINEERS

- Savior
- Guardian
- Bureaucratic Servant
- Social Servant
- Social Enabler/Catalyst
- Game Player



SAVIOR

- Rescues systems from technical threats
- Example: Engineers solving Y2K crisis



GUARDIAN

- Foresees future tech directions
- Provides guidance for sustainable growth



BUREAUCRATIC SERVANT

- Loyal, skilled problem-solver
- Trusted with decisions and leadership during crises



SOCIAL SERVANT

- Works for societal good without self-interest
- Fulfills government-mandated tasks



SOCIAL ENABLER / CATALYST

- Connects company and society
- Helps both recognize and achieve shared goals



GAME PLAYER

- Operates within business rules
- Balances services with economic realities



WHAT IS PROFESSIONALISM?

- Covers skills, ethical conduct, and decision-making
- Doing the right thing regardless of feelings



PROFESSIONAL IDEALS & VIRTUES

- Public-Spirited Virtues
- Proficiency Virtues
- Teamwork Virtues
- Self-Governance Virtues
- Supported by motives, attitudes, and emotions



PUBLIC-SPIRITED VIRTUES

- Focus on public welfare and avoid harm
- Promote safety, community engagement, and justice



PROFICIENCY VIRTUES

- Competence – effective performance
- Diligence – alertness and care
- Creativity – innovation in tasks



TEAMWORK VIRTUES

- Cooperation and loyalty to peers and org
- Motivate team toward shared goals



SELF-GOVERNANCE VIRTUES

- Integrity, courage, perseverance, self-respect
- Truthfulness and trustworthiness



RESPONSIBLE PROFESSIONALISM

- Integration of all virtues in practice
- Foundation for ethical engineering conduct



SUMMARY

- Profession demands commitment beyond skill
- Professionalism is rooted in ethical virtue
- Engineers must be role models in society



DISCUSSION / REFLECTION

- How can an engineer balance economic interest with social duty?
- Which professional model do you relate to most, and why?



ENGINEERING ETHICS: SOCIAL EXPERIMENTATION

Presented by: Dr. Razib Hayat Khan

INTRODUCTION

- Engineering improves life through technology and efficiency.
- Social experimentation involves practical use with human subjects.
- Not conducted under controlled lab conditions.

ENGINEERS AS EXPERIMENTERS

- Trial and error method is common.
- Preliminary simulations are used to test designs.
- Experiments carry risks and uncertainties.

RESPONSIBILITY IN EXPERIMENTATION

- Ensure safety of human subjects.
- Obtain informed consent.
- Communicate project risks and nature.
- Monitor results and accept accountability.
- Demonstrate professionalism.

CONSCIENTIOUSNESS

- Engineers should have a strong moral awareness.
- Must balance employer obligations with public responsibility.
- Be prepared for unexpected outcomes and be accountable.

INFORMED CONSENT

- Engineers must inform stakeholders about project nature and risks.
- Avoid producing harmful or illegal products.
- Suggest better alternatives when necessary.

MORAL AUTONOMY

- Commitment to moral values leads to responsible behavior.
- Personal responsibility earns trust and improves outcomes.

ACCOUNTABILITY

- Moral responsibility is essential in teamwork.
- Both credit and failure must be accepted.
- Engineers cannot avoid personal responsibility.

CODES OF ETHICS

- Developed by AAES, ABET, NSPE, IEEE, AICTE.
- Help engineers stay committed to ethical conduct.

ROLES OF CODES OF ETHICS

- Protect public health and safety.
- Offer guidance and motivation.
- Promote shared standards and professionalism.
- Support ethical professionals.

MORE ROLES OF CODES

- Promote education and mutual understanding.
- Deter unethical behavior and provide discipline.
- Improve profession's image and reduce need for regulation.

ADVANTAGES OF CODES

- Define ideals and responsibilities.
- Protect professionals and clients.
- Enhance professional image.
- Provide regulatory guidance and consistency.

CONCLUSION

- Engineering ethics guide responsible innovation.
- Ethical codes build public trust and ensure professionalism.